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Graduate Recruitment Team

Capula Investment Management LLP

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Capula's launch of a systematic commodities fund in 2026, its first major move beyond fixed income, overlaps directly with my own commodity research.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. My lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 came from respecting variance and sizing risk to a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and as Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

Capula stands out to me because it is extending a rigorous, quantitative approach from bonds and currencies into raw materials: its new Capula Alternative Markets Alpha Fund trades commodities algorithmically, with room for \$2 billion to \$3 billion of capital. My dissertation tests whether storage and news data improve forecasts of gas volatility, and whether better forecasts survive a realistic trading test, and I would like to learn how a firm with Capula's discipline turns that kind of research into risk across its trading functions.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan